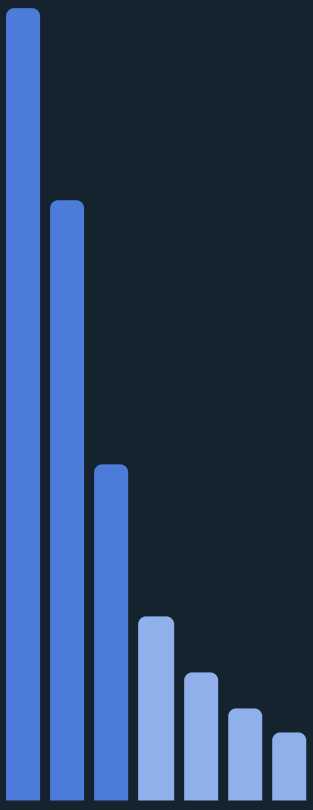
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BUSINESS GUIDE



Five Signs Your Product Range Is Leaking Market Share

Why a narrow range on the dealer's shelf caps your share, and what range-led planning does differently.

5
warning signs

10-point
scorecard

10 min
read

WHY THIS GUIDE

Most manufacturers don't have a demand problem. They have a range problem.

The market is asking for more than the shelf carries. Dealers stock the few SKUs that move fastest, and the rest of the catalogue sits in the plant or at the distributor. New launches take months to reach the counter and still miss the segment they were built for.

Meanwhile rivals win the premium or value end while your mix stays where it was. Primary billing looks healthy, so nobody sees share slipping away one counter at a time.

This guide covers five warning signs that range, not demand or price, is the constraint, and what changes when range is run from channel signals.

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01 SIGN ONE

Dealers stock only a few of your products

If a dealer carries 5 of your 60 products, your share at that counter is capped, no matter how good the other 55 are.

What it looks like

- Best-sellers get re-ordered. The rest of the range is never tried.
- The channel asks for SKUs you do not carry, while unlisted SKUs sit in stock.
- Sales teams push what is easy to sell, not what the territory needs.
- Range sold per dealer is not measured at all.

What it costs

Share is lost one counter at a time, quietly, while primary billing looks fine. By the time it shows up in the numbers, a rival's products already hold the shelf space.

WHAT RARE OS CHANGES

The system reads secondary sales and channel signals to show, dealer by dealer, which SKUs the territory buys elsewhere. It turns that into a short list of products to place at each counter.

02 SIGN TWO

New products take months and still miss the segment

If a launch is judged by what left the plant, not what sold at the counter, you learn it missed only when it is too late.

What it looks like

- Launches are judged on primary dispatch, not on retail movement.
- NPD briefs come from internal opinion, not from channel data.
- Launch stock sits at distributors instead of moving to the counter.
- By the time a launch is fixed, a rival owns the slot.

What it costs

Launch spend without share. The catalogue grows every year, but the number of products that actually sell does not, and the field stops trusting new launches.

WHAT RARE OS CHANGES

Demand-sensing and NPD signals from the channel tell product teams what the segment is asking for before the brief is written. Launch movement is then tracked at retail from week one, not at dispatch.

03 SIGN THREE

A few best-sellers carry the whole business

If a handful of SKUs bring the revenue while the rest sit in stock, your range is narrowing, not growing.

What it looks like

- The top 20% of SKUs bring most of the revenue, while the tail drags on working capital.
- Slow SKUs are never phased out, because nobody owns the decision.
- Production runs favour volume SKUs, which narrows the range further.
- Promotions keep pushing the same few lines.

What it costs

Capital is frozen in a tail the market is not asking for, and the range narrows every year as production and promotions follow the same few lines.

WHAT RARE OS CHANGES

An SKU rationaliser flags which tail SKUs to phase out and which to push where, by region and sub-segment. Capital moves out of the tail and into the products that grow share.

04 SIGN FOUR

Rivals are winning the premium or value end

If competitors keep filling price points and formats you already knew about, the gap was never the idea. It was the decision.

What it looks like

- Competitors launch into gaps you can see but never act on.
- Your mix stays mass while the segment trades up, or down.
- Price points between your SKUs are left open for others to fill.
- Feedback from the field never reaches product planning.

What it costs

The segment grows and your share of it shrinks. Dealers move the premium or value buyer to a rival brand, because your range has nothing at that price.

WHAT RARE OS CHANGES

Premium-versus-mass mix and assortment depth are tracked by sub-segment. Gaps show up as actions while there is still time to act, not as a year-end post-mortem.

05 SIGN FIVE

Nobody can say which SKU to push where

If nobody can name the SKUs each outlet should add this week, range is being run by habit, not by signal.

What it looks like

- Range decisions are made once a year, in a review.
- Marketing, sales and plant each hold a different view of the range.
- Regional differences are averaged away in the national plan.
- There is no daily list of what to place in which outlet.

What it costs

Range stays a slide, not an operating rhythm. Each team acts on its own view, and the gap between what the market asks for and what the shelf carries keeps widening.

CLIENT EXAMPLE · KIRLOSKAR OIL ENGINES

Entry into pump sets: product and sourcing strategy for a 250-SKU range across 8 OEMs and 4 states in six months. Around 80% of a Rs 100 Cr, three-year target was reached within the timeline.

WHAT RARE OS CHANGES

One daily action list per role: expand these SKUs in these outlets this week, phase these out, chase this gap. Each action carries a market-share number against it, so the team can see what moved.

THE ALTERNATIVE

What changes when range runs from channel signals

Your catalogue, plant and ERP stay as they are. What changes is where range decisions come from: the channel, not the annual review.

	Range today	Range-led (RARE OS)
How range is decided	Annual review, internal opinion	Channel and secondary-sales signals, daily
Where stock sits	Volume SKUs, everywhere	The right SKUs, outlet by outlet
New launches	Judged on dispatch	Tracked on retail movement from week one
Tail SKUs	Never phased out	Rationalised by region and segment
What the field gets	A price list	A short list of what to place, where
Range per dealer	Not measured	Tracked as a share number

How range becomes daily action

Sense Read channel and secondary-sales signals.

Decide Which SKUs to expand, phase out or launch, by segment.

Act A daily list per role, measured against range sold per dealer.

It sits on top of your ERP. It is called RARE OS, an operating system for moving market share. Most companies start with one product family and one region.

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Scorecard: where do you stand?

Tick each statement that is true for your business today.

- [ ] 01 Dealers carry only a small share of our catalogue.
- [ ] 02 We do not track range sold per dealer.
- [ ] 03 The channel asks for SKUs we do not make.
- [ ] 04 A few best-sellers bring most of our revenue.
- [ ] 05 Slow SKUs are rarely phased out.
- [ ] 06 Launches are judged on dispatch, not retail movement.
- [ ] 07 New products take many months to launch.
- [ ] 08 Rivals have launched into gaps we saw first.
- [ ] 09 Range decisions are made once a year.
- [ ] 10 Sales, marketing and plant hold different views of the range.

0–2 ticks

Your range is reaching the counter. Review range per dealer each quarter.

3–5 ticks

Share is leaking at some counters. One family in one region will show where.

6 or more

Range, not demand, is now the constraint on your market share.

NEXT STEPS

Start with one family, one region

1. **Pick one product family and one region**
   Choose one where dealers carry only part of the range.
2. **Pull 12 months of primary and secondary sales**
   Dispatch, dealer-level sales and the SKU master are enough to start.
3. **Map range sold per dealer against what the territory buys**
   See which SKUs each dealer could carry and does not.
4. **Act on the short list, measure, then scale**
   Prove the result in one region before extending to more families.

Scored 3 or more? Get a free range health check.

In a free 30-minute range health check, we review your scorecard and show you where range is capping your share, dealer by dealer. No obligation.

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